

THE WHARTON SCHOOL

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT WHARTON

Wharton is the world's oldest collegiate business school. As part of the venerated trinity known as HSW (Harvard/Stanford/Wharton), it is consistently ranked among the top three programs in global MBA rankings.

Long dominant in finance, Wharton has expanded its strengths into other realms. The entrepreneurial community at the school has surged in the past eight years, with a higher percentage of students graduates starting a business after earning their degree than at Harvard Business School. Tangen Hall, its signature entrepreneurship space, offers further evidence of the exciting ways the business school continues to evolve beyond its roots in finance to also drive entrepreneurial innovation.

Wharton also claims one of the highest percentages of women in a top MBA program. For example the class of 2024 was 50% female. The 2020 appointment of Dean Erika James, representing both the first woman and first Black person to serve as dean in Wharton's 139-year history, positions Wharton and its community even more uniquely as leaders in business advancing broader global impact.

The incorporation of the Team Based Discussion into the admissions process gives further testimony of Wharton's inclusive values, which are a far cry from the outdated stereotype of a competitive student body.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

General Management, Finance, Health Care, Entrepreneurship, Real Estate, Nonprofit/Social Responsibility, International Management, Economics, Big Data. Over 200 electives on offer.

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*

	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
BusinessWeek	2	2	6	6	*	*	7
Financial Times	3	3	4	2	*	1	-
US News	1	3	1	1	2	2	3
Poets and Quants	1	1	4	3	3	3	1

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	6,319	Avg Work Experience	5
MBA Class Size	877	Avg GMAT	733
Total Tuition	US\$169,748	International	35%
		Women	50%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Financial Services	38.6%
Consulting	24.3%
Technology	16.9%
Starting Own Business	6.9%
Healthcare	5.6%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Accenture, McKinsey, BCG, Bain & Co., Blackrock, Credit Suisse, Deloitte, Doordash, Amazon, Apple, Goldman Sachs, Google, Morgan Stanley, Pfizer, Pepsico

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$175,000

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 98.7%



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR WHARTON APPLICATION

BY DR. JUDITH SILVERMAN HODARA

Judith served as a core member of admissions committees at the University of Pennsylvania for almost two decades, most recently as Acting Director at the Wharton School's MBA Program. She was also an Associate Director in the Office of Undergraduate Admissions at the University of Pennsylvania.



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1

DEMONSTRATE YOUR TEAM ORIENTATION

One of the common stereotypes is that Wharton is an “eat or be eaten” kind of environment. Contrary to popular belief, uber-competitive Wharton is actually home to an extremely collaborative and team-oriented learning environment. The utilization of learning clusters, cohorts, and teams (you may work with 15+ over your time in the program) provide a platform for collaboration and learning to lead through teamwork. Accordingly, your application needs to reflect your ability to actively contribute and thrive in these settings. Individuals who present themselves as lacking a team-orientation or having a leadership style that is closed, rather than facilitative, will be at a disadvantage in terms of being invited to interview and ultimately being granted admission.

BALANCE YOUR PERSONAL & PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

2

Wharton does look at each applicant file holistically understanding that what you do for a living is not who you are or what you will bring to the community. You certainly would not want someone to consider you only by your profession, so it's a good idea to use some balance within the framework of your application. Your essay examples should reflect things that the committee may not know about you from outside the workplace, in addition to showcasing your professional skills. If you can keep in mind that you are a sum of about 10,000 parts, and show that in the application, the admissions officers will see that passion and connection too.

3

CONVEY YOUR INTEREST IN WHARTON

Choosing to focus on a particular field of interest in your application is key. Of course, applicants have a variety of interests that they intend to pursue during their MBA. However, in the application it may not be a good idea to be a generalist. Therefore you may want to speak specifically about a professor or a class or a club that interests you, and have them all be connected, so that there is a theme to your writing. With 200 other electives and an incredibly rich student life there are any number of ways to immerse yourself in the MBA experience so think about how you can contribute and make a difference.

ADCOM'S VIEW OF NON-TRADITIONAL BACKGROUNDS

4

Wharton actively encourages applicants coming from non-traditional backgrounds to apply to the school. In addition to bringing a wealth of diversity to the classroom discussion from an industry perspective, applicants from this sector have often also had non-business undergraduate academic interests. This combination helps to add to the energy of the classroom and club interactions. With the breadth of the University of Pennsylvania's graduate programs, where students can take up to 4 classes outside of the Wharton program and receive credit, it is not surprising that many Wharton students take classes in other related fields that would further their career paths in non-profit work, such as at the School of Education or School of Social Policy and Practice.

5

PRESENT YOUR CAREER PLAN

It's important within the context of the application process to show that you have a career path in mind. Students who indicate that they have "so many ideas that they don't know where to start" come across as unfocused and non-directed.

The Wharton Vice Dean once famously said, "If we only granted diplomas to those of you who had followed your suggested career paths from your applications, no one would actually graduate!" The beauty of a transformational business school education is that it gives you tremendous exposure to possibilities on a professional and personal level. However, Wharton admissions officers want to ensure that you can create a viable path to follow and that you enter the program with a sense of purpose. Business school has been likened to drinking water from a fire-hose, and those who come in with no plan at all are frequently hosed down by the blast. It is advisable to give as much detail as you can about next steps in your career, showcasing that you understand what the Wharton program will allow you to do along the way.

For more insider insights into Wharton please visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	INTERVIEW INVITATIONS	FINAL DECISIONS
Round 1	06 September 2023	24 October 2023	14 December 2023
Round 2	04 January 2024	16 February 2024	26 March 2024
Round 3	02 April 2024	19 April 2024	13 May 2024
Deferred Admissions	24 April 2024	28 May 2024	27 June 2024



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson, and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

